Gartner

Critical Capabilities for Data and Analytics Governance Platforms

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Initiatives: Strategy, Risks and Opportunities

A D&A governance platform helps D&A leaders design, implement and monitor governance policies. Vendors in this market provide an integrated set of capabilities to primarily support policy setting and enforcement-related governance responsibilities for data and its derived assets, inclusive of AI.

This Critical Capabilities is related to other research:

Magic Quadrant for Data and Analytics Governance Platforms

View All Magic Quadrants and Critical Capabilities

Overview

Key Findings

- According to the 2025 Gartner Evolution of D&A Governance for AI Survey, data governance tools and data management platforms are the most common tools used to operationalize AI governance elements, such as AI-ready data governance and AI policies. However, they vary in their capabilities to fully govern those assets.
- The data and analytics (D&A) governance platform market is expanding governance accountability to the policy execution layer. Vendors with data management capabilities that have expanded into governance use cases by adopting policy setting and policy enforcement capabilities perform best at policy execution.
- Vendor strategies for D&A governance platforms are diverging as some vendors choose to focus on one specialty (such as lineage or data quality) and rely on partners for the rest, while others pursue the full-scale platform model via acquisitions and consolidation.

Recommendations

- Before evaluating and selecting a best-fit D&A governance platform for your organization, identify your key governance objectives, use cases and the roles that will support them.

- Identify your required D&A governance capabilities based on business context (e.g.,the need to govern unstructured and semistructured data). Ensure that your prioritized capabilities are supported by the platform, either natively or through partnerships. It's important to clarify whether these prioritized capabilities exist currently or if they are on the vendor's roadmap, as this market is rapidly evolving.

- For policy setting and enforcement use cases, prioritize the support that the platform provides to nontechnical roles. Do not focus disproportionately on policy execution requirements if you have separate data management tools and platforms that address those needs already.

- Assess the suitability of D&A governance vendors in your broader data management architecture in terms of connectivity for active metadata use via data mesh, data fabric and other data ecosystem structures.

What You Need to Know

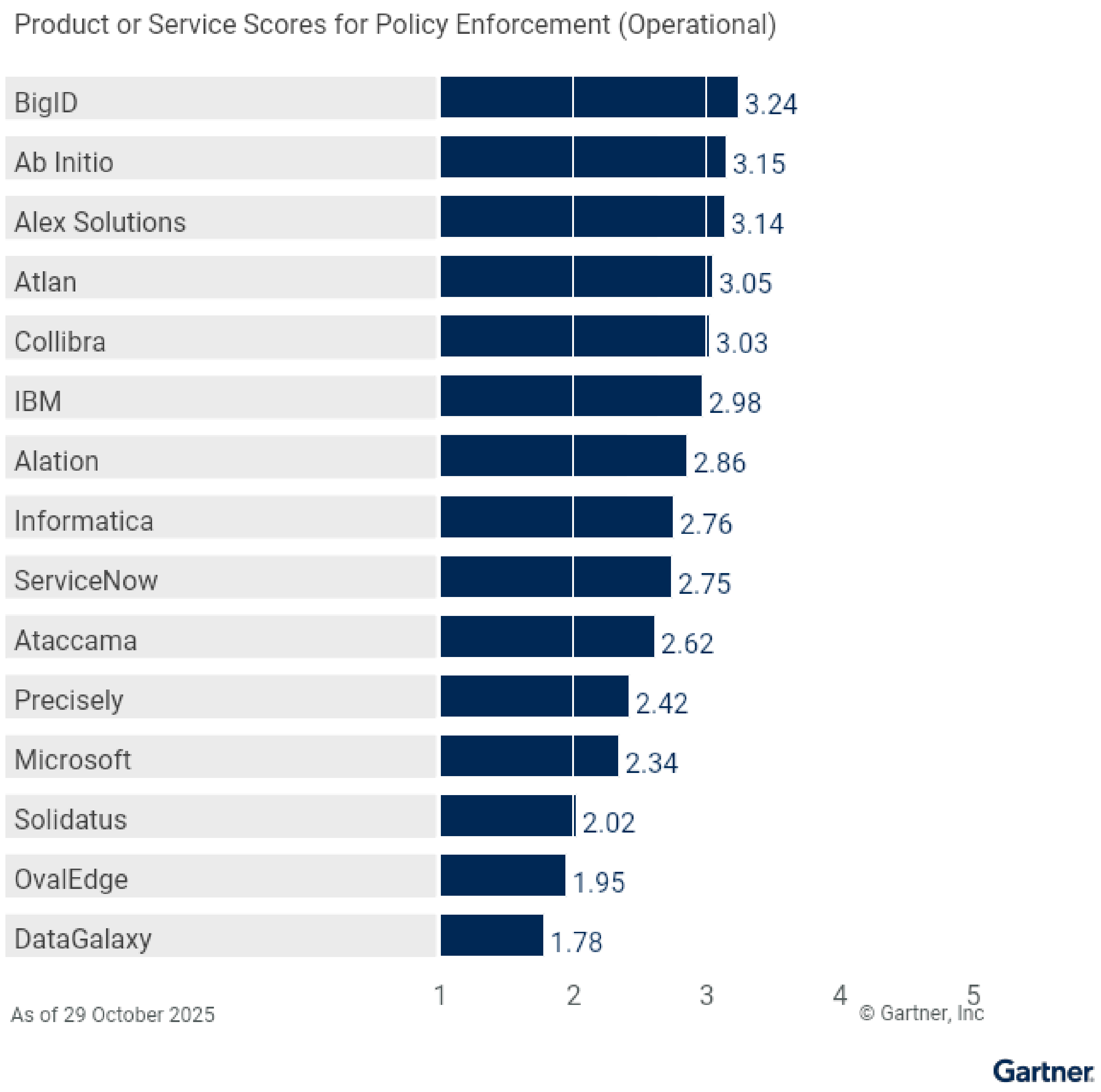
The market for D&A governance platforms continues to grow. D&A is a composite market: the data-management-related segments (database management system [DBMS], data integration, data quality, master data management, metadata management, DataOps and data observability) grew by 12.9% to $133 billion in 2024. We observe that D&A governance platforms represented roughly a $2 billion market in 2024, with current and forecast market growth well above other data-management-related segments.

Much like how D&A governance is a business capability that relies on IT/data management for performing the technical steps of policy execution, the D&A governance platform primarily serves the business stakeholders for scaled policy setting and enforcement (monitoring). At the same time, it integrates with data management technologies (storage, data integration, DataOps) to execute governance workflows. The D&A governance platform you choose and the capabilities you prioritize should complement your current and planned data management architecture (refer to How to Align Data Management to Accelerate Data Governance).

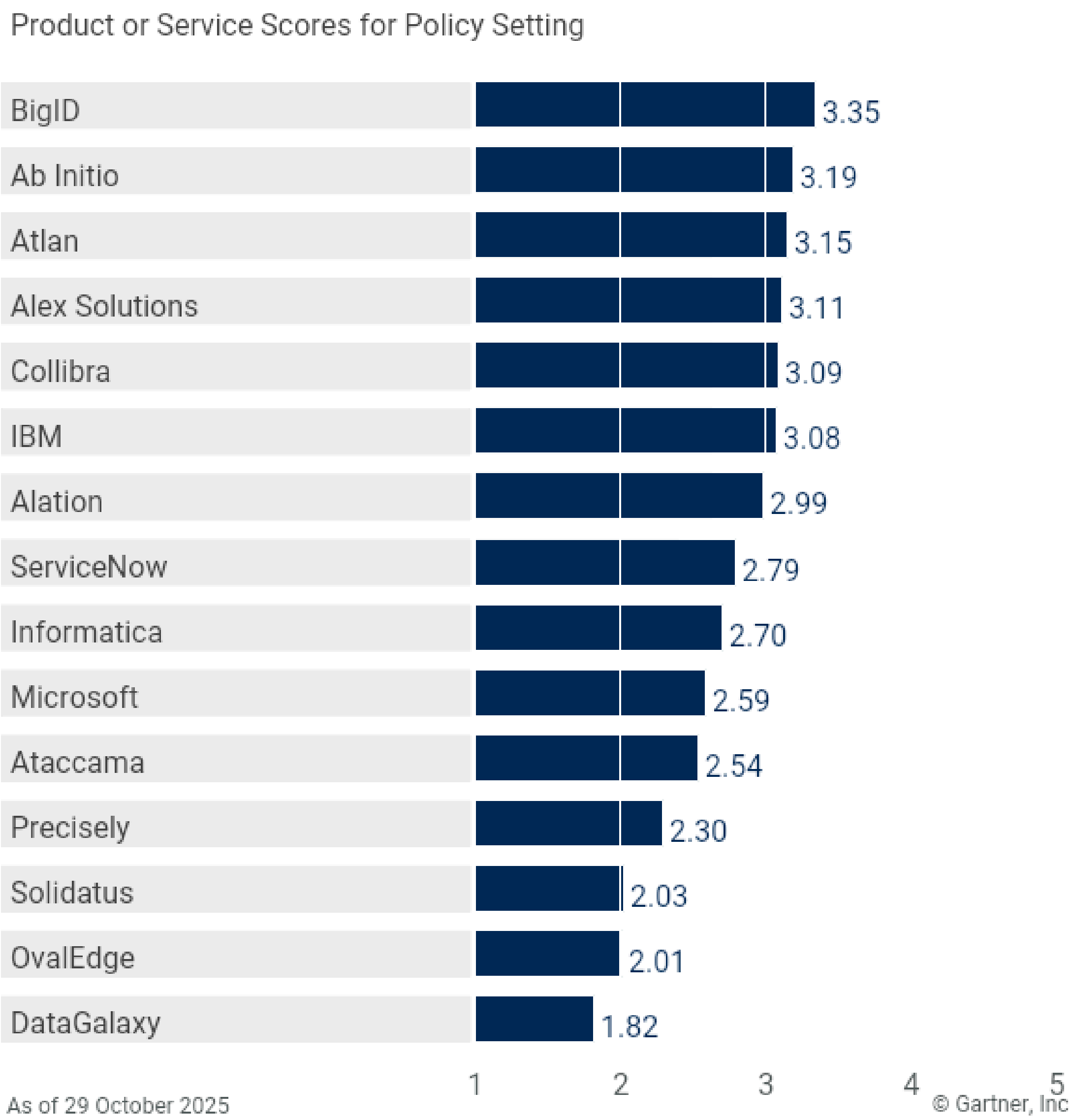
Analysis

Critical Capabilities Use-Case Graphics

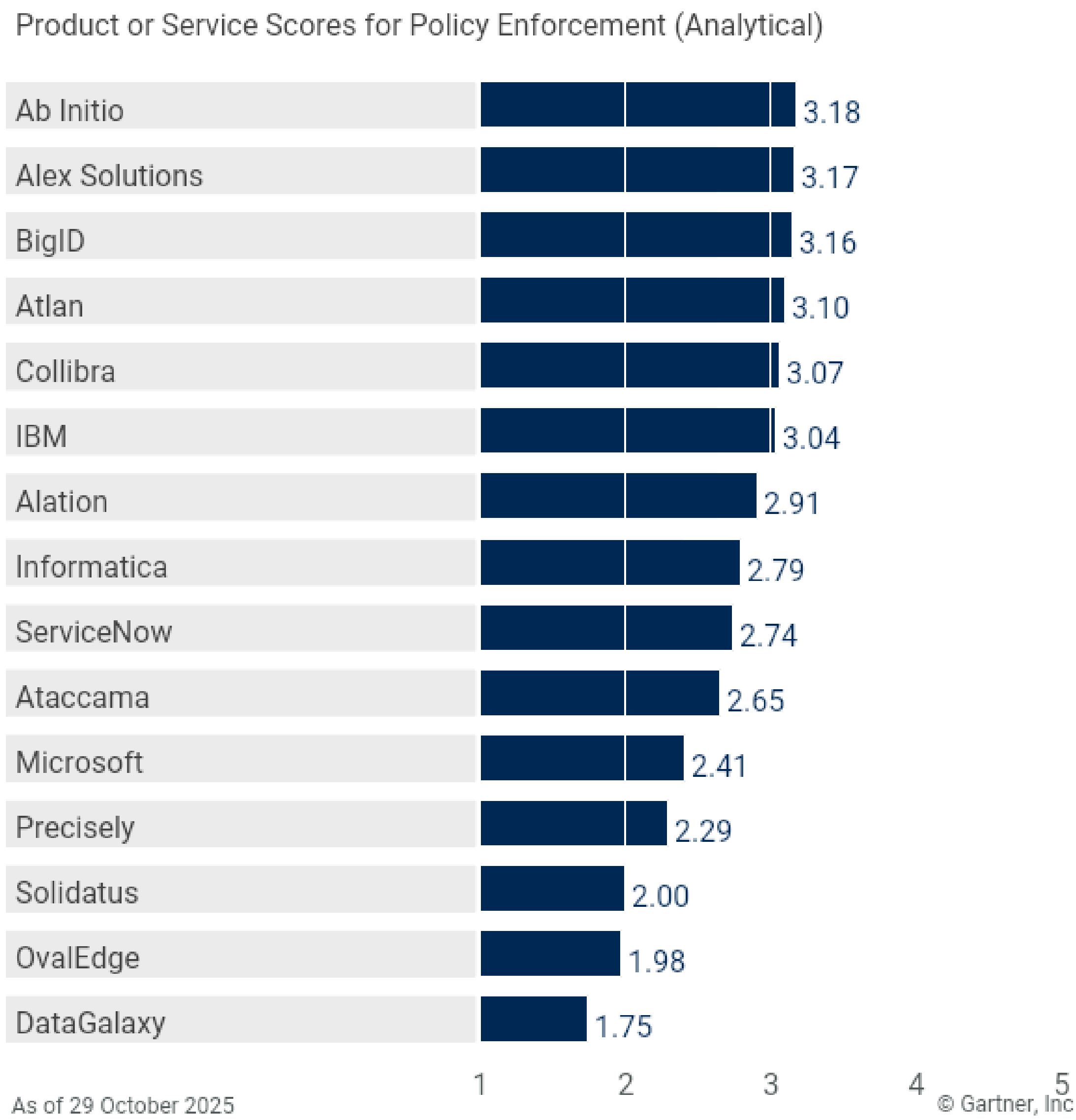
Vendor Product Scores for the Policy Enforcement (Operational) Use Case



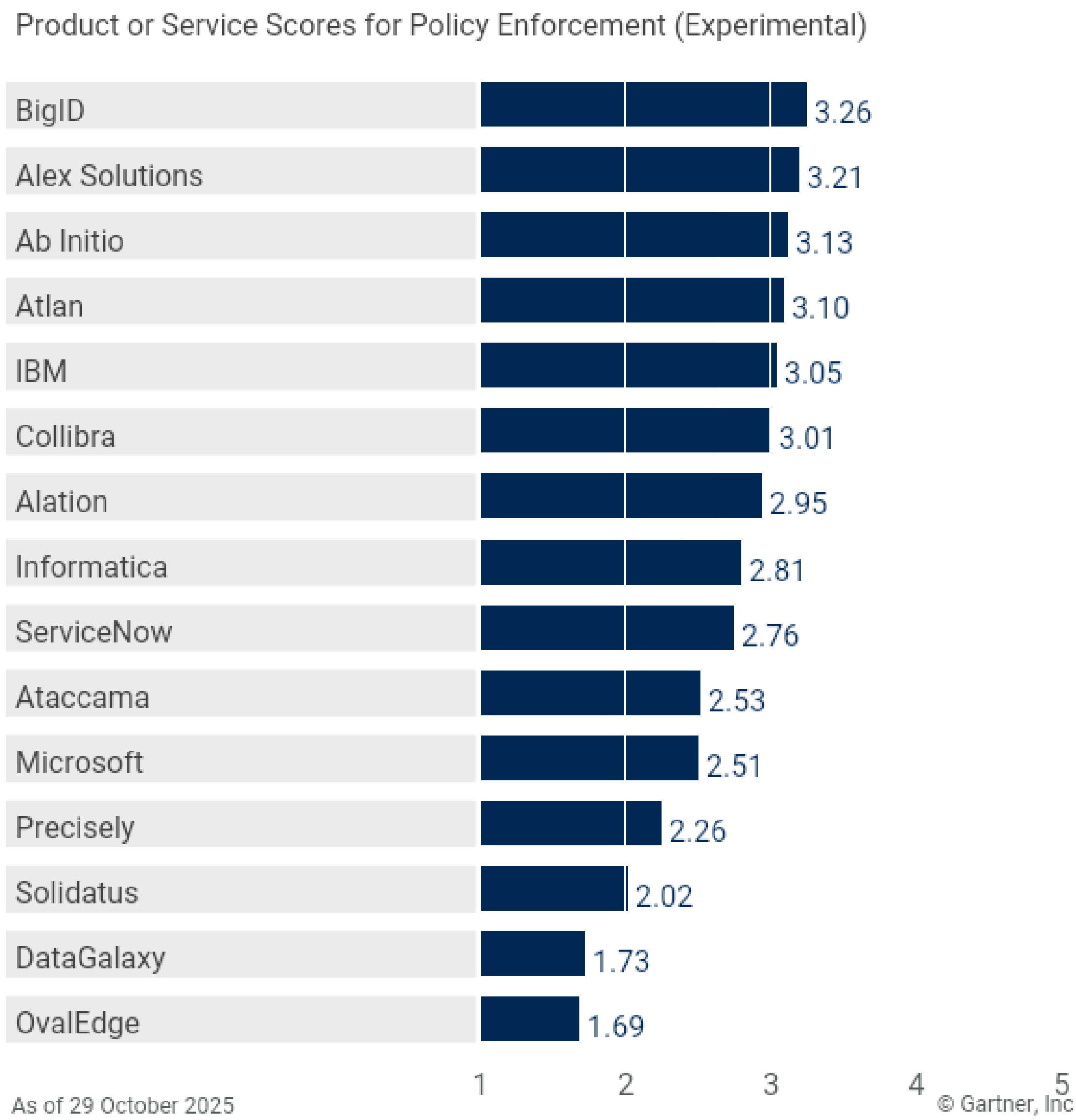
Vendor Product Scores for the Policy Setting Use Case



Vendor Product Scores for the Policy Enforcement (Analytical) Use Case



Vendor Product Scores for the Policy Enforcement (Experimental) Use Case



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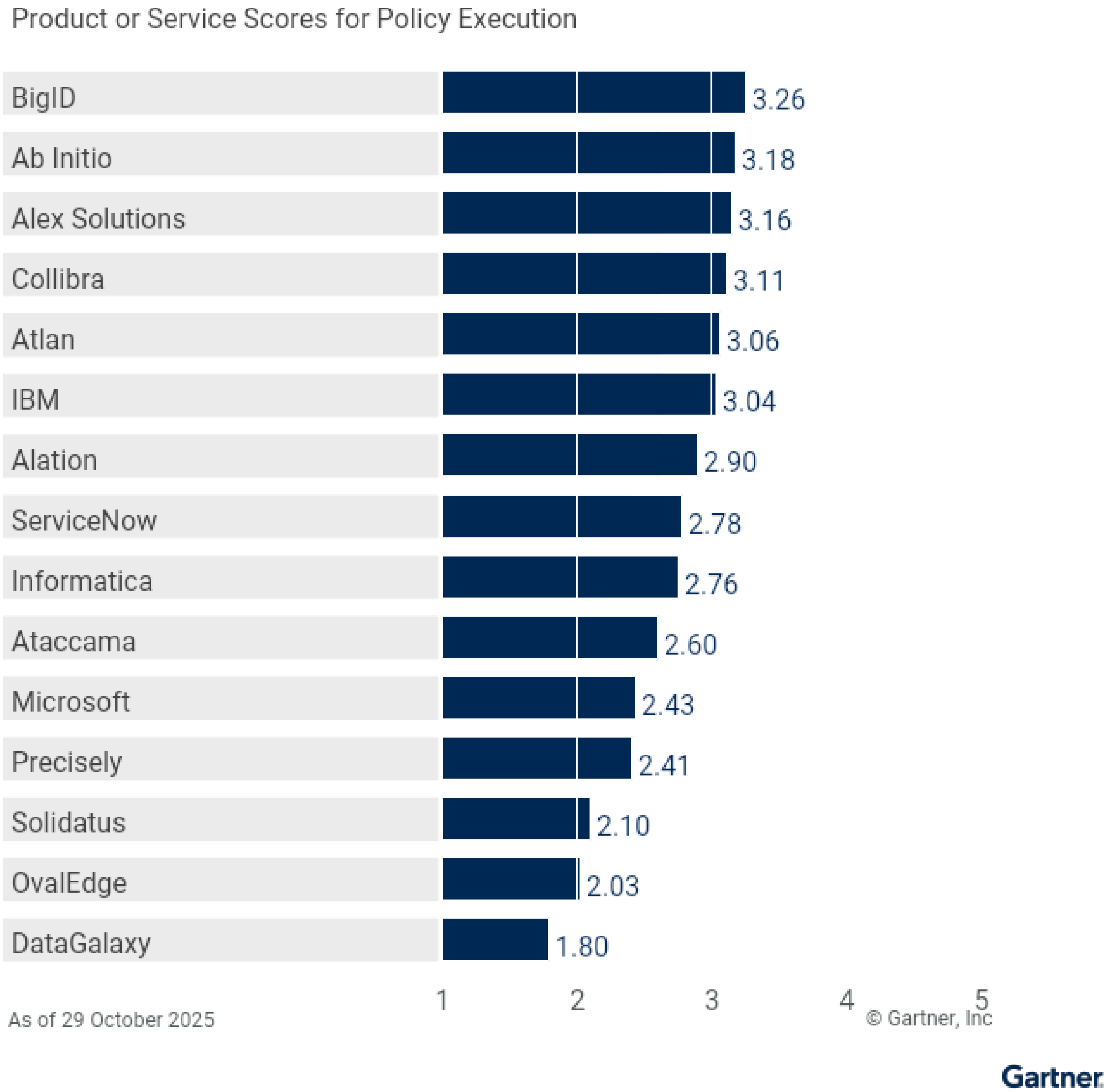
Vendor Product Scores for the Policy Execution Use Case



Vendors

Ab Initio

Ab Initio's platform for governance is the Data Platform/Metadata Hub, which is offered as a flexible deployment option across various environments, including cloud, on-premises, virtual machines, containers and cloud marketplaces. The platform encompasses user context and personas, semantic terms and ontologies, operational information, catalog, lineage, marketplace data, semantic rules, controls, and agentic AI instructions.

Ab Initio's platform features an agentic AI semantics catalog that leverages machine learning (ML), small language models (SLMs) and large language models (LLMs) for semantic discovery with reinforcement learning, allowing users to interact using business terms and corporate ontologies. The product enables the definition of business rules and controls at a semantic level, abstracting physical data details, which are then applied universally across the enterprise, with AI agents converting free text or extracting rules from documents. The platform also functions as a comprehensive data catalog (including complex lineage maps) by collecting and integrating metadata from many cloud and on-premises sources as well as other catalogs, with an open and extensible schema and various connectors.

For its individual capability scores, Ab Initio scored well in data dictionary, business glossary, lineage (upstream and downstream), and rule management (traditional and iterative). It scored lowest in UI for stewardship. For its individual use-case scores, Ab Initio scored higher in policy setting and policy enforcement (analytical) and lower in policy enforcement (experimental). Ab Initio is frequently chosen for its data management features, including comprehensive data integration and support for preparing data for AI applications.

Alation

Alation's platform includes: Data Catalog (foundation of the Agentic Data Intelligence Platform), Data Governance, Data Quality, Data Lineage, Analytics and Data Products Marketplace. These offerings are available as SaaS options in the AWS cloud or can be deployed in an infrastructure as a service (IaaS) configuration on AWS, Google Cloud and Microsoft Azure. The products can also be installed on-premises or in private cloud environments.

Alation's cloud-native, microservices-based platform manages metadata across structured and unstructured environments, integrating with lakehouse and cloud ecosystems. It includes features such as a lineage graph, object metamodel, and over 120 connectors for databases, business intelligence tools, data lakes and ETL platforms. The system automates metadata discovery, enrichment, and sharing across technical, operational and business domains. AI is used for metadata curation, documentation and quality control, and behavioral analytics to deliver insights into data usage and adoption. Specific governance features include Policy Center, Stewardship Workbench, workflow management, orchestration, automation, policy controls and role-based access. Document Hubs provide standardized templates for metadata and governance documentation, supporting compliance and risk management for data and AI projects. The system supports semantic search and natural language interaction through AI agents. It provides lineage, impact analysis and policy enforcement via integrations, but does not include advanced profiling or entity resolution as built-in features. Alation is developing agentic metadata and GenAI agents focused on automating stewardship tasks, contextualized data assets, and trusted AI.

For its individual capability scores, Alation scored higher for security and data catalog and lower for matching, linking and merging. For its individual use-case scores, Alation scored higher in policy setting and lower in policy enforcement (operational). Alation is often selected for its data catalog, including support for data products.

Alex Solutions

Alex Solutions' platform includes Unified Data Intelligence Platform, Data Hub, OpenMetaHub, Intelligent Connectors, Alex AI Guru, and Enterprise Reporting and Analytics. It is cloud-agnostic and offers SaaS and managed services for both hosted and on-premises deployments. The platform can be deployed as a single server instance (for simpler and small-scale deployment) or multiserver instance (to support specific projects or federated governance).

Alex Solutions extracts and visualizes lineage from a range of systems across the data life cycle and visualizes it through an interactive interface. Its lineage capabilities also extend to unstructured data. The platform automatically calculates trust scores for data assets, allowing users to develop and operationalize trust models. The platform supports governance of AI, trust scoring and collaborative workflows for model certification and life cycle management. The embedded AI-powered offering (Alex AI Guru) supports conversational governance for multiple platform capabilities, including translation of technical logic, which explains AI features used in governance, advanced matching and compliance reporting.

Alex Solutions' strongest individual capabilities include lineage (upstream and downstream) and rule management (traditional and iterative). Its support for governing AI models includes automated discovery and enrichment of model metadata, end-to-end lineage tracking, real-time policy enforcement, and integration with analytics and machine learning tools. Alex Solutions delivers stewardship functionality through dynamically composed, role-based dashboards and workflow views across both the platform UI and ERA. It provides a standards-based, enterprise-grade workflow engine with conversational workflow initiation. However, some advanced configurations may require additional technical expertise.

Alex Solutions' strongest use cases include policy enforcement (analytical and experimental). It is frequently chosen for its comprehensive offering supporting scalability and compliance, and its conversational, AI-powered approach that makes it accessible for business and technical users alike.

Ataccama

Ataccama's governance platform, Ataccama ONE, includes data catalog, business glossary, data quality, metadata management and master data capabilities. It is cloud-agnostic and runs PaaS, SaaS, multicloud, private cloud and hybrid deployments. However, its GenAI features and AI agent are only available in cloud deployments.

Ataccama is well-balanced across all use cases. Its data catalog supports curated data products and profiling, and monitoring and detection capabilities. Also, automation is built in, from rule creation to bulk application of rules. This is part of the platform's "AI-first" direction, applying automation across its capabilities for a proactive approach to governance. Its customers appreciate that the automation capabilities allow for reuse of already-created components, such as workflows, especially in managing data quality.

Ataccama's strongest individual capabilities are data profiling, data dictionary and data catalog. Its data catalog capabilities, including automated metadata discovery, continuous scanning, and profiling, make it well-suited for analytical governance needs. The data dictionary supports both technical and business metadata. It scored lowest in security and information policy representation capabilities. Ataccama's security capabilities are limited, specifically lacking orchestration of data security controls across different data sources and environments. It does not have prepackaged rules for AI-specific regulations and has limited out-of-the-box industry and geographic frameworks for data policy modeling. For its individual use-case scores, Ataccama scored higher in policy enforcement (operational and analytical), and is well-suited to scenarios where data quality policies are prioritized. Limitations in its ability to continuously monitor and govern AI models and data throughout the model life cycle make it less-suited to experimentation use cases.

Atlan

Atlan is a single-platform, cloud-native and cloud-agnostic, metadata management and governance product offered as SaaS, PaaS and managed services deployment. Traditional on-premises and private cloud environment deployments are not available, but serviced through secure agents in a hybrid deployment.

Atlan takes a partnership and co-innovation-based approach, which is reflected in its focus on Atlan App Framework as a marketplace for context (metadata) and comprehensive environment for accelerating third-party development of connectors and apps. The underlying metadata lakehouse architecture boosts performance, scalability, extensibility, and time travel auditability, which has improved its capabilities in discovery, lineage, granularity in governance reporting, and support for unstructured data governance via partners.

For its individual capability scores, Atlan scored higher in data dictionary and data catalog. Atlan provides support for data product creation, with strong metadata management, life cycle control, multichannel delivery, feedback mechanisms and enforceable data contracts that are embedded as metadata. It scored lower in security and matching, linking and merging. Native support is limited for some capabilities, such as out-of-the-box persona-based UIs, profiling, quality remediation workflows and security controls (particularly for unstructured data). Atlan's strongest use cases are policy setting and policy enforcement (analytical and experimental). Its policy center enables defining, storing, cascading, and querying policies across all data and metadata assets with automation support. It also enables policies to be written, versioned and managed as code (policy as code), which is ideal for the CI/CD and DataGovOps workflow in analytics pipelines. The platform emphasizes customer-driven customization, but it may not be ideal for those seeking a single, standardized solution that covers a wide range of needs out of the box.

BigID

BigID's modular platform, BigID Next, is built for discovery and classification, with additional modules and apps required for an integrated governance product. It is cloud-agnostic with multiple deployment options, including on-premises, SaaS and multitenant or single-tenant managed services. Hybrid deployment is also supported, so sensitive workloads can remain on-premises while policy management happens in the cloud. This is useful for organizations with strict data residency or sovereignty requirements.

BigID's platform features extensive out-of-the-box connectors, including those for structured and unstructured sources, and point governance solutions (such as AI governance platforms). This allows for a broad coverage of data and derived assets. The platform needs to further expand its capabilities to support governance priorities relevant to leaders beyond security leaders. For example, its trust-based dynamic classification is based predominantly on data sensitivity, residency, and access controls, which makes it suitable for security, privacy, and compliance teams, but does not adequately cover broader dimensions such as adoption, data quality scores, and stewardship actions performed.

BigID's strongest individual capabilities are security and information policy representation, with its features including classification, policy automation, audit, and reporting. It also offers AI/ML-enabled classification capabilities for tagging and triggering policies. It scored lower in lineage (downstream) and UI for stewardship. For its individual use-case scores, BigID scored higher in policy execution, setting and enforcement. The platform performs relatively low on policy enforcement (analytical), due to limited lineage capabilities across analytical data stores and analytical development platforms. There is also limited support for creation and management of data contracts for data products. This platform is a good option for heavily regulated organizations where security, risk and D&A leaders are looking for a single platform to complement their integrated governance operating model.

Collibra

Collibra's platform includes Collibra Data Governance, Collibra AI Governance, Collibra Data Catalog, Collibra Data Lineage, Collibra Data Quality & Observability, Collibra Data Privacy and Collibra Protect. It provides a unified platform for data and AI governance, connecting data producers and consumers through its semantic graph. Its deployment options include SaaS, PaaS, IaaS, multicloud, private cloud, FedRAMP cloud and hybrid environments. Recent acquisitions of Raito and Deasy Labs will bolster Collibra's capabilities in governing data products, data access and unstructured data.

Collibra scored well across all use cases evaluated this year. Its catalog includes a data marketplace and data product management, providing a single point of access to governed data products by data consumers. It also features end-to-end business and technical lineage and traceability via AI lineage, which combines models, training data, and outputs. Collibra's semantic graph is accessible to multiple personas based on their consumption needs, improving usability of the platform and providing the context needed to confidently consume data.

Among Collibra's strongest capabilities are data catalog and lineage (upstream and downstream). It differentiates itself from others through its emphasis on unification. However, the platform shows opportunities for improvement in its UI for stewardship capability, which could benefit from additional customization options. The platform can appear complex to customers who are early in their governance maturity journey. That said, it's worth noting that the emphasis on AI capabilities for automated stewardship demonstrates Collibra's vision for the evolution of its platform in the future. This platform is a good option for those who engage consulting partners to design and stand up their broader data governance programs, with Collibra as a core component of that larger strategy.

DataGalaxy

DataGalaxy's governance platform includes the Metadata Hub and its recently launched Strategy Hub. The Metadata Hub includes catalog, access management, lineage connectivity, and data quality and observability integration functions. The platform can be run on all major public clouds as well as on-premises. It offers SaaS, private cloud and hybrid deployments. Some AI features are not available in on-premises deployments.

DataGalaxy is mostly used in the financial services, insurance and public sector industries, but has worked to expand beyond the traditional regulatory and privacy focuses of those industries with its value governance approach. The platform seeks to provide a user-friendly experience so less time is spent on non-value-add tasks, which is particularly beneficial to its small and midsize enterprise customer base, where individuals often have to wear many hats.

DataGalaxy scored low across use cases because it does not currently extend to unstructured data, and the platform lacks native data quality and observability capabilities. Its highest-scoring use case is in policy setting. Its "value lineage" approach, enabled by a knowledge graph, connects policies to strategic data initiatives, unifying technical and business users' priorities. DataGalaxy's strongest capability is its business glossary, which includes an audit trail and has connections between catalog, dictionary and glossary elements modeled in a knowledge graph. Within workflow management, it notably has out-of-the-box KPIs and reports and allows for customization of governance and business-outcome-level measures. Its lowest capabilities were in rule management (iterative) and data profiling. Customers from small and midsize organizations with well-defined, targeted governance use cases will benefit from fast deployment time (less than two months).

IBM

IBM has consolidated its previously separate modules into an integrated platform under the watsonx portfolio. This suite includes watsonx.data intelligence, watsonx.governance, watsonx.data, watsonx.data integration, watsonx.ai, and watsonx BI. The platform is built on a microservices architecture. The watsonx.data intelligence product now combines governance capabilities that were formerly sold as IBM Knowledge Catalog, Manta Data Lineage, and Data Product Hub. Deployment options are flexible, including managed SaaS on IBM Cloud or AWS, self-managed software, and managed services for on-premises and multicloud environments.

IBM demonstrates balanced performance in all use cases, though it performs particularly well in policy setting. Its policy enforcement (operational) use case is somewhat constrained by its relatively lower scores for classification and tag management capabilities, offering fewer predefined classification policies and templates compared to competitors. IBM provides strong capabilities, including its data catalog, data quality, data lineage and data product management, through watsonx.data intelligence.

In this evaluation, a particularly strong capability for IBM is its data catalog, which has many augmented capabilities such as GenAI and ML to automatically enrich technical metadata and an integrated lineage experience where business metadata and a data quality score appear on the lineage graph to support root cause analysis. It scores lower in UI for stewardship and business glossary. The platform seeks to augment the role of people in governance processes with GenAI features, including the ability to autocreate the business glossary. IBM is a good option for organizations that are already leveraging the IBM ecosystem and are seeking governance capabilities that span structured and unstructured data.

Informatica

Informatica's Intelligent Data Management Cloud (IDMC) has the following integrated capabilities: data catalog, data governance, access and privacy, data marketplace, data quality and observability, data integration and engineering, and API and app integration. It is a collection of xPaaS services delivered as a unified platform offered on all major cloud ecosystems.

Informatica's strongest use cases are experimental and analytical policy enforcement, though it displayed well-balanced scores across all use cases. It has a data marketplace, which provides visibility into available data through search, along with its governance requirements, quality ratings and more, thanks to connectivity with the data catalog. Users can explore lineage through the marketplace as well. AI capabilities exist to recommend and take actions, and governance extends to AI model lineage, versions, and validation of data within the models. Policy enforcement use cases can be extended into execution, thanks to the platform's strong capabilities in DataGovOps, such as policy as code, and a sandbox for SDLC.

Informatica's strongest individual capabilities include data dictionary, lineage (downstream) and rule management (iterative). The platform captures detailed lineage within data stores, and across traditional and advanced analytics systems and processes at system, dataset, and column levels. This includes interactive views for both business and technical users. However, it shows opportunities for improvement in UI for stewardship and workflow management. The platform does not currently offer the ability to integrate workflows with third-party business process management tools. Organizations looking to scale a strong foundational governance operating model may find Informatica to be a good option.

Microsoft

Microsoft's governance platform, Purview, is built on Azure and primarily offered as a fully managed SaaS product; a PaaS offering is available, but with limited capabilities. On-premises deployment of the core platform is not supported, but a proxy service can be deployed behind a corporate firewall to enable bidirectional communication with on-premises data sources.

Microsoft leverages tools and partners in the Microsoft environment to further extend capabilities that Purview does not have strength in; for example, CluedIn, Profisee, Semarchy, and Reltio for entity resolution/MDM capabilities. It is strongest in the policy setting use case. Security capabilities like role-based access control, audit logging, sensitivity labeling, encryption, masking, and DLP can be applied to data assets discovered and cataloged from both Microsoft and non-Microsoft environments. It is certified for a wide variety of global standards (such as GDPR, SOX, NIST AI RMF, and the EU AI Act), supporting its compliance and regulatory policymaking abilities. It has over 200 built-in classifiers, support for custom/trainable rules, and AI/ML-driven recommendations for identifying sensitive data.

Purview's capabilities are limited by absent features that are common in the governance platforms market, such as native knowledge graph support, versioning and auditing control, deep profiling, and it lacks automation for cataloging, quality remediation, and insight discovery and sharing. Its strongest individual capabilities are security, as well as data classification and tag management. The UI for stewardship is an area of opportunity, with limited customization capabilities to ensure engagement with nontechnical users, which has been reported by current users. Purview is a good option for Microsoft-first organizations with limited automated governance capabilities or security-driven governance considerations.

OvalEdge

The OvalEdge platform includes six core modules: data catalog; business glossary; data quality; data lineage; service desk, projects and workflows; and privacy and compliance. It can be deployed as SaaS (exclusively supported on AWS) or private cloud (available on AWS, Microsoft Azure or Google Cloud Platform). Its knowledge graph-based AI assistant, askEdgi, supports natural language search across the data catalog in on-premises deployments, while it has wider capabilities, including advanced conversational analytics, in the SaaS deployment.

OvalEdge scores low across use cases due to limitations in security, rules management and analytics models. Its strongest use cases are policy execution (which is bolstered by its workflow management capability) and policy setting. OvalEdge natively provides business process modeling to design and visualize governance workflows and processes. It also provides more than 40 out-of-the-box collaboration workflows for a variety of needs, including external data acquisition, publication of data products, and data product access. All of its prebuilt workflows are also fully customizable.

OvalEdge's strongest capability is its workflow management, followed by data catalog. Nontechnical users benefit from enhanced exploration of the data catalog through the use of askEdgi's natural language capabilities. The platform's overall strength lies in its ability to scale, as a governance program gains capability by adding on modules over time. Its biggest areas of opportunity lie in security, where it does not provide monitoring, reporting or auditing of security incidents, and in its lack of matching, linking and merging capabilities. Its capabilities for analytics models are also extremely limited, with no integration with tools and environments for developing AI and no evaluation of data's fitness for specific AI use cases. OvalEdge is a good option for those with needs specific to workflow management, as it leverages connectors and is affordable.

Precisely

Precisely's governance product is a SaaS solution, Precisely Data Integrity Suite. It has agents that can interface with customer data systems, which can be deployed in hybrid, private cloud or on-premises environments.

Precisely's strongest use case is policy enforcement (operational). It enables business terms to be linked to any asset type, providing contextual relationships. It also emphasizes classification and tagging as a means to govern through its catalog. Matching, linking and merging data can be done at the data's source and includes AI/ML-based matching and grouping. Its information policy representation limits the policy setting use case, because there are no prepackaged rules for AI-specific regulations, nor is there out-of-the-box support for industry and geographic regulations for policy modeling. While the platform utilizes AI, several common capabilities are not yet generally available, including NLP and bidirectional synchronization of metadata with third-party tools. Customers often report engagement with its data strategy consulting team to establish initial governance policies, processes, organizational roles and risk assessment methodologies. While the platform offers self-service features, full value and optimal configuration may require consulting engagement. That said, the platform has a 91% customer retention rate over the past 12 months.

Precisely's strongest individual capabilities include data dictionary and matching, linking and merging. Its matching, linking and merging features are strong, with multilingual support that matches data using transliteration and allows for non-Roman characters to be brought into the Latin character set. Its biggest areas of opportunity include information policy representation and rule management (iterative). The iterative rule management capability is limited by lack of support for DataGovOps principles. Precisely is best suited for organizations with targeted, defined governance use cases to support.

ServiceNow

ServiceNow has acquired the data.world Enterprise Data Catalog & Governance Platform, which is designed to support its data control tower vision. It is a cloud-native SaaS platform that can be deployed as managed services, multicloud or hybrid. The governance platform can be purchased stand-alone or bundled with the Workflow Data Fabric.

ServiceNow's strongest use cases are policy setting and policy execution. For policy setting, the platform supports both manual and automated tagging, allows users to define and manage custom tags, and supports registering and managing unstructured data assets as catalog entries. For policy execution, it has a comprehensive set of out-of-the-box collaboration workflows. Its policy enforcement use cases are limited by capabilities such as profiling, which does not apply to streaming data sources. The platform also has limitations in its native profiling features, though it supports connection to external tools for that purpose.

ServiceNow's strongest capabilities include business glossary, data catalog, lineage (upstream and downstream), and data classification and tag management. The business glossary is customizable, categorizable, includes an audit trail and leverages a knowledge graph to reconcile semantic variation. ServiceNow's classification and tag management includes quality scores alongside tags, which improves usability and discoverability; it also leverages ML for classification. Capabilities with the strongest opportunities for improvement include UI for stewardship and data profiling. Menus cannot be dynamically programmed (except via configuration files), and the platform does not provide translations between rules stored in the repository and client interfaces. Customers within the ServiceNow ecosystem will benefit from its connectivity to the Workflow Data Fabric, enabling semantic understanding of data and knowledge graph.

Solidatus

The Solidatus platform is cloud-environment-agnostic, but favors Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud Platform due to existing partnerships. It is a SaaS product, though customers have regularly deployed Solidatus in multicloud, private cloud and hybrid environments with no difference in functionality.

Solidatus positions itself as a technical and business data lineage product and has been selected as the only strategic lineage partner for Microsoft Purview and Fabric; it is listed in the Azure Marketplace and Microsoft Security Store. Its strongest use case is policy execution, due to the platform's focus on metadata and lineage. Its focus makes it most user-friendly toward a technical audience, which is why it is less-suited for other, more business-facing use cases such as policy setting and enforcement. However, even its technical-facing features are complex and its customers note limited customization abilities.

Solidatus' strongest individual capabilities include lineage (upstream and downstream), data dictionary, and analytics models. Its upstream lineage strengths come from its ability to connect to and pull metadata from major ERP and CRM systems. It automatically builds lineage models and provides an interface for manual lineage modeling where that is required. For analytics models, it allows users to define and document data requirements for specific AI use cases, ingesting data quality and profiling metrics from external tools to determine fitness of the data for the use case. Its greatest areas of opportunity are data profiling, as well as matching, linking and merging. Its low capability in things like quality and profiling are addressed by supporting bidirectional integration with data catalog and data quality platforms, as well as regulation-focused organizations. Solidatus is best suited for large, complex organizations.

Context

This report is a companion to the Magic Quadrant for Data and Analytics Governance Platforms and evaluates the vendor offerings with respect to five specific governance use cases and 15 critical capabilities, versus the general market overview presented in the Magic Quadrant. The focus of this Critical Capabilities research is on the functionality of the products in specific governance scenarios, but the weights of each capability can be modified to suit an organization's specific needs and priorities.

Market Definition

A data and analytics governance platform is a set of integrated business and technology capabilities that help business leaders and users develop and manage a diverse set of governance policies and enforce those policies across business and data management systems. These platforms are unique from data management in that data management focuses on policy execution, whereas D&A platforms are used primarily by business roles — not only or even specifically IT roles — for policy management.

Data and analytics (D&A) leaders who are investing in operationalizing and automating the work of D&A governance should evaluate this market. The work of D&A governance primarily includes policy setting and policy enforcement, and collaborates with data management (policy execution). Use cases are employed across numerous governance policy categories and multiple business scenarios and asset types (data, KPIs, analytics models). The intersection of use-case/business scenarios, policy categories and assets to be governed is then used to identify the technology capability. These capabilities may share similar names across policy categories, but may not mean the same thing, or may be used differently by various governance personas. For example, data classification in a data security implementation would be quite different from a data classification effort for creating trust models, which would be based on lineage and curation.

Mandatory Features

The must-have features for this market include:

- **Policy-setting solution:** Operationalize, serve, and automate the work of data and analytics governance stakeholders involved in setting policies (governance board, data owners) using:
  - Information policy representation (high level): Model, store and access (for state and/or persistence) a business representation of the governance policies being enforced, with integration and links to business rules enumerated in the various applications.
  - Organization and role models: Set up organizational models and associated user IDs with key roles across the various workflows and the intersection of work related to policy setting and policy enforcement. An example is setting up models that tag real people to data elements, tasks, workflows, rules and more.
  - Workflow management: Support and automate governance workflows with capabilities including business process modeling, data flow modeling and documentation, and support for analytics key performance indicators (KPIs) and other benchmarking efforts to monitor business impact of D&A governance.

- **Policy enforcement solution:** Operationalize, serve and automate the work of data and analytics governance stakeholders involved in enforcing policies (business data stewards, analytics stewards) using:
  - Business glossary: Develop and use a glossary in support of policy analysis and development. It includes the ability to support taxonomies and ontologies to address semantic variations. This expands from business glossaries to identifying relationships between data elements, synonyms and (preferably) support ontologies and semantic relationships (business metadata), and is part of broader data cataloging capability.
  - Data lineage and impact analysis: Identify data provenance using the depth and breadth of data lineage. Data lineage must be broad because it must audit and, wherever needed, infer all the steps, applications and transformations that any data element has gone through from its original source to all the possible endpoints, including AI models. The capability is also leveraged to identify the impact of a change on any metadata element. It must be deep to allow for drilling down or analyzing to the finest level of detail, such as column-level or transformation logic.
  - Orchestration/automation: Align data governance with modern data management practices and technologies. Leveraging AI/ML, active metadata, GenAI, AI agents, these capabilities automate and optimize key functions like data quality, integration, cataloging and insight generation, ensuring that data is accurate and relevant. In data governance, “augmented” means using active metadata and AI and machine learning (ML) to enhance decision making and enforce policies effectively. These capabilities also support data democratization, enabling nontechnical users to participate in data processes while maintaining governance standards.
  - User interface (UI) for stewardship: Support the skills and needs of a variety of stakeholders involved in policy enforcement, including business data stewards and analytics stewards, and provide them with collaborative workflows. Address a variety of users with an interface that is easy to use and engaging to interact with. The UI should enhance the experience that users have while interacting with the solution/product and ensure that different personas find the appropriate virtual environment in which to work. It should also create a collaborative experience.

- Task management: Set up, assign and reassign tasks across the organizational roles involved in policy setting, enforcement (including exception management) and external roles/users. Management tools such as dashboards and work-to lists are provided to monitor the status of tasks.

- Rule management (low level): This capability automates the enforcement of business rules that are tied to data elements and associated metadata. It supports dedicated interfaces for the creation of, and the order of execution and links with, information stewardship for effective governance.

- **Connectivity/integration:** Provide facilities for loading (import) and exporting metadata, including roles, in a fast, efficient and accurate manner in conjunction with other third-party tools. These facilities provide a communication backbone for the bidirectional flow of metadata between the central repository and the data sources or other participating/consuming applications downstream. The solution should support interoperability and, potentially, harmonization of metadata.

Common Features

The common features for this market include:

- **Data catalog:** Inventory, curate and query multistructured data and its derived assets. The inventory capabilities are enabled by machine learning (ML) and automatic detection of relationships with other data assets. The catalog capability extends to provide marketplace experience to curate certified data products backed by data contracts.

- **Data dictionary:** Manage technical metadata about data elements that are being used or captured in a database, information system or as part of a research project. This capability is associated with a metadata repository, and is used to perform analysis using metadata. Organizations can also use repositories to publish information about reusable assets, which enables users to browse metadata during life cycle activities such as design, testing and release management.

- **Data classification:** Organize data by relevant categories so that it may be used and protected more efficiently. On a basic level, the classification process makes data easier to locate and retrieve. Data classification is particularly important for risk management, compliance, data security and trust.

- **Data profiling and visualization:** Conduct statistical and business-rule-based analysis of diverse datasets (ranging from structured to unstructured data and from internal to external data) to give business users insight into the quality of data and enable them to identify data quality issues.

- **Match, link, merge (entity resolution):** Use a variety of traditional and new approaches, such as rules, algorithms, metadata and ML, to match, link and merge related data entries within or across diverse datasets.

- **Governance model management:** Review, edit, explore and otherwise interrogate various models (data, policy, rule, organizational, etc.) and various states and conditions over time as relevant for governance work.

- **Security** (on the platform itself): Provision certain data security policies through data risk assessment and orchestration of data security controls that are available on the governance platform. The controls enact data access privileges, audits or monitoring to enable certain levels of security provision by the platform.

- **Tag management:** Enable enrichment through user tagging of content or automatic detection, such as personally identifiable information/data (PII or PID). This capability should also provide context (such as tagging and rating) to enable data analysts, data scientists, data stewards and other data consumers to identify and integrate access to additional relevant datasets for the purpose of enhancing business value.

- **Analytics models:** Govern the iterative advanced analytics and AI models by capturing versioning models and reports and promoting them from development to testing to production environments.

- **Data observability:** Provide insight into the health of an organization's data landscape, data pipelines and data infrastructure by continuously monitoring, tracking, alerting, analyzing and troubleshooting incidents to reduce and prevent data errors or downtime. This capability tells not only what went wrong, but also why, and assesses the impacts. Data observability improves reliability of data pipelines by increasing the ability to observe changes, discover unknowns and take appropriate actions.

Product/Service Trends

Trends from last year's evaluation continue to impact this market, including platform convergence, inclusion of AI governance capabilities, platform positioning as the point of access to governed data products, and automation and augmentation of governance tasks with AI.

Acceleration has happened in the following areas in the past year:

- **Unstructured data governance:** Vendors in this market have responded to customer demands to govern data for AI use cases by building connectors for unstructured data sources; tracking lineage, parsing, classification and chunking; and vectorizing capabilities where the governance platform operates in a broader data management ecosystem.

- **Horizontal market consolidation:** In addition to governing data for AI and governing AI use cases, this market is experiencing consolidation of capabilities through acquisitions and/or partnerships with vendors that specialize in specific policy types (security, privacy) and data types (master data), and those that target specific personas beyond D&A leaders (CISO, risk, legal). This results in a more streamlined and consolidated user experience through a single platform.

- **Consumerization 2.0:** The market has advanced beyond the baseline of providing marketplace capabilities for business roles to consume governed data products. Now, many platforms have added advanced capabilities with AI agents, such as agentic data product creation, and connectivity to business applications' AI agents.

- **Agentic governance for policy enforcement:** Workflow management has evolved with AI, too, incorporating agents to automate workflows, making them more efficient than manual or even augmented processes. This is closing the gap between policy enforcement (monitoring) and execution at the data management layer.

Critical Capabilities Definition

Rule Management (Iterative)

The automated enforcement and execution of business rules that are tied to data elements and associated metadata in iterative workflows, such as DataOps.

Data Classification and Tag Mgt

Ability to organize data by relevant categories for easy discovery and retrieval for risk management, compliance, data security and trust, as well as enrichment through user tagging of content or automatic detection, such as personally identifiable information/data (PII or PID).

Data Dictionary

Management of the technical metadata about data elements that are being used or captured in a database, information system, or as part of a research project. This capability is associated with a metadata repository and is used to perform analysis using metadata.

Business Glossary

The ability to develop and use a glossary in support of policy analysis and development. It includes the ability to support taxonomies and ontologies to address semantic variations.

This expands from business glossaries to identifying relationships between data elements, synonyms, and (preferably) support ontologies and semantic relationships (business metadata).

Information Policy Representation

A place to model, store, and access (for state and/or persistence) a business representation of the governance policies being enforced, with integration and links to business rules enumerated in the various applications.

Security

Ability to provision certain data security policies through data risk assessment and orchestration of data security controls that are available on the governance platform. The controls enact data access privileges, audits or monitoring to enable certain levels of security by the platform.

Data Catalog

The ability to inventory and curate data assets. Data inventory capabilities are enabled by ML and automatic detection of relationships with other data assets. A data inventory requires a user-augmented process for validating and resolving any ambiguity in the automated inventory process.

Data Profiling

The ability to conduct statistical and business-rule-based analysis of diverse datasets (ranging from structured to unstructured data, and from internal to external data) to give business users insight into the quality of data and enable them to identify data quality issues.

Matching, Linking, Merging

This is the matching, linking and merging of related data entries within or across diverse datasets using a variety of traditional and new approaches, such as rules, algorithms, metadata and ML.

Analytics Models

Governance of iterative advanced analytics and AI models by capturing versioning models and reports and promoting them from development to testing to production environments.

Rule Management (Traditional)

The automated enforcement of business rules that are tied to data elements and associated metadata. It supports dedicated interfaces for the creation of, and the order of execution and links with, information stewardship for effective governance.

Workflow Management

Automated governance workflows with capabilities including business process modeling, data flow modeling and documentation, and support for analytics key performance indicators (KPIs).

Lineage (Upstream)

Includes the depth and breadth of data lineage for identifying data provenance. Data lineage must be broad because it must audit all the steps, applications and transformations that any data element has gone through, from its original source to all the possible endpoints specific to upstream.

Data lineage can also be inferred through ML to bridge possible gaps in the metadata. Data lineage also supports security and privacy because it helps to identify data as it evolves across structured and unstructured formats and locations.

Lineage (Downstream)

Includes the depth and breadth of data lineage for identifying data provenance. Data lineage must be broad because it must audit all the steps, applications and transformations that any data element has gone through, from its original source to all the possible endpoints specific to downstream.

Data lineage can also be inferred through ML to bridge possible gaps in the metadata. Data lineage also supports security and privacy because it helps to identify data as it evolves across structured and unstructured formats and locations.

UI for Stewardship

The capabilities via an interface to support the skills and needs of a variety of stakeholders involved in policy enforcement, including business data stewards and analytics stewards, and provide them with collaborative workflows.

Use Cases

Policy Setting

Focuses on the establishment of rules to inform how data assets should be collected, stored, accessed, shared, retained and protected.

It ensures specification of decision rights and an accountability framework for data and analytics that is aligned with business and regulatory requirements.

Policy Enforcement (Operational)

This use case focuses on enforcing data governance policies to the data created, housed and maintained in operational applications within business domains.

This ensures operational efficiency, appropriate behaviors and decision making.

Policy Enforcement (Analytical)

Focuses on ensuring trusted and quality data for distributed roles and teams to perform self-service analytics and share data products within organizational guardrails.

Policy Enforcement (Experimental)

Focuses on ensuring advanced analytics roles develop experimental models in an environment that scales for production while maintaining explainability, compliance and trust.

Policy Execution

This use case focuses on how action is derived from established policies via the processes put in place against the data.

It ensures visibility into how policies are followed and made auditable by various enterprise roles at central and domain levels.

Vendors Added and Dropped

Added

- BigID
- Microsoft

Dropped

Anjana Data: Anjana Data did not meet the inclusion criteria of "impact" based on the Customer Interest Indicator (CII) identified by Gartner for this Magic Quadrant. The CII shows the market momentum for the vendor in this market.

Global Data Excellence: Global Data Excellence did not meet the inclusion criteria of "impact" based on the Customer Interest Indicator (CII) identified by Gartner for this Magic Quadrant. The CII shows the market momentum for the vendor in this market.

Quest Software: Quest Software was excluded from this year's Magic Quadrant, as Quest was in the midst of making a strategic pivot for its product and brand during the period of evaluation. The focus on being a broad data management platform for AI doesn't fit the market description prima facie.

Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

The inclusion criteria are the specific attributes that a provider must have to be included in this research.

To qualify for inclusion, providers must demonstrate support of the criteria below (organized in different categories):

General availability (GA)

Offer stand-alone platform solutions that are positioned, marketed, and sold specifically for general-purpose data and analytics governance applications. Vendors that provide several D&A governance product components must demonstrate that these are integrated, and collectively meet the full inclusion criteria for this research.The platforms must demonstrate the capabilities as available in GA from June 2025.

Product or service capability

Policy setting operationalization and augmentation through a set of capabilities:

- Information policy representation
- Organization and role model
- Workflow management

Policy enforcement operationalization through a set of capabilities:

- Business glossary
- Data lineage and impact analysis
- Orchestration/automation
- User interface (UI) for stewardship
- Task management
- Rule management (low level)

Connectivity and integration with operational and analytical data systems.

Support for the augmentation and automation of at least five capabilities through AI/ML (including NLP based on LLM support), knowledge graph, and active metadata.

Capability in large-scale deployment (in terms of number of concurrent users, and data volume) via architectures that can support concurrent users and applications. All deployment types should support capabilities listed above. Vendors must showcase at least 10 large scale deployments (more than 500 users/more than 50 data sources/more than 1,000 data assets) .

The solution is intentionally geared primarily toward non-technical users involved in governance work. They are supported by end-user functionality for the following types of users: business data steward, analytics stewards (stewards operationalizing governance in analytics pipelines), data scientists, business intelligence analyst, citizen users, data architect, data quality analyst, data engineer, database administrator, data integration analyst.

Support for integration and interoperability with other data management and governance-related solutions, such as metadata management, master data management, data quality, data security platforms, and AI governance platform from third-party tools.

Demonstrate in at least three business scenarios how the platform operationalizes and automates policy setting, policy enforcement, and policy execution (in conjunction with existing data management technologies).

Performance

Maintain an installed base of at least 50 production paying customers (different companies/organizational entities/logo) for their flagship data governance solution (not just individual smaller modules or capabilities). The customers must be running in production for at least one month.

Provide direct sales and support operations, or a partner providing sales and support operations in at least two of the following regions: North America, LATAM, EMEA, and Asia/Pacific.

Impact

Rank among the top 25 organizations in the Customer Interest Indicator (CII) identified by Gartner for this research. CII was calculated using a weighted mix of internal and external inputs that reflect Gartner client interest, vendor customer engagement, and vendor customer sentiment in the last 18 months.

Data inputs used to calculate D&A governance market momentum included a balanced set of measures:

- Gartner.com search
- Inquiry volume
- Frequency of mention in Peer Insights competitors
- Google Trends search index
- Number of followers on X (formerly Twitter) and LinkedIn
- Average visits per month according to web traffic analysis

Geographic coverage

The customer base for production deployment must include paying customers in multiple countries (at least five) and in two or more regions (North America, LATAM, EMEA, and Asia/Pacific).

Industry coverage

The customer base must be representative of three or more industry sectors.

Table 1: Weighting for Critical Capabilities in Use Cases

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Critical Capabilities	*Policy Setting*	*Policy Enforcement (Operational)*	*Policy Enforcement (Analytical)*	*Policy Enforcement (Experimental)*	*Policy Execution*
Data Catalog	10%	5%	15%	10%	10%
Data Dictionary	10%	5%	5%	5%	10%
Business Glossary	5%	5%	5%	5%	0%
Information Policy Representation	20%	5%	5%	5%	5%
Workflow Management	10%	10%	10%	5%	15%
Lineage (Upstream)	5%	15%	5%	5%	10%
Lineage (Downstream)	5%	5%	10%	5%	10%
UI for Stewardship	5%	10%	10%	5%	5%
Rule Management (Traditional)	5%	10%	5%	0%	10%
Rule Management (Iterative)	0%	0%	10%	15%	0%
Data Classification and Tag Mgt	15%	15%	5%	5%	10%
Security	10%	5%	5%	10%	10%
Data Profiling	0%	5%	5%	10%	0%
Matching, Linking, Merging	0%	5%	5%	0%	5%
Analytics Models	0%	0%	0%	15%	0%

Gartner (January 2026)

This methodology requires analysts to identify the critical capabilities for a class of products/services. Each capability is then weighted in terms of its relative importance for specific product/service use cases.

Critical Capabilities Rating

Each of the products/services that meet our inclusion criteria has been evaluated on the critical capabilities on a scale from 1.0 to 5.0.

Table 2: Product/Service Rating on Critical Capabilities

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Critical Capabilities	*Ab Initio*	*Alation*	*Alex Solutions*	*Ataccama*	*Atlan*	*BigID*	*Collibra*	*DataGalaxy*	*IBM*	*Informatica*	*Microsoft*	*OvalEdge*	*Precisely*	*ServiceNow*	*Solidatus*
Data Catalog	3.3	3.2	3.4	3.2	3.4	3.3	3.4	2.0	3.5	2.9	2.8	2.5	1.8	3.0	1.9
Data Dictionary	3.5	3.1	3.2	3.3	3.5	3.3	3.2	2.0	2.8	3.1	2.7	2.0	2.8	2.8	2.5
Business Glossary	3.5	2.9	3.0	3.1	3.3	3.1	2.8	2.2	2.7	2.8	2.3	2.2	2.5	3.1	2.0
Information Policy Representation	3.3	3.0	3.0	2.0	3.2	3.6	3.2	1.6	3.3	2.4	2.7	2.0	1.7	2.6	1.9
Workflow Management	2.8	2.7	2.8	2.5	2.9	3.1	3.3	2.0	3.0	2.3	2.2	2.9	2.3	2.7	2.4
Lineage (Upstream)	3.5	3.1	3.5	2.7	3.0	3.2	3.4	1.8	3.0	3.0	2.0	2.1	2.5	3.0	2.5
Lineage (Downstream)	3.5	3.1	3.4	2.8	3.2	2.5	3.4	1.8	2.9	3.1	2.1	2.2	2.6	2.8	2.6
UI for Stewardship	2.6	2.9	2.8	2.5	3.0	2.8	2.4	1.6	2.4	2.3	1.8	1.8	2.4	2.2	1.7
Rule Management (Traditional)	3.5	3.0	3.5	2.3	3.0	3.3	3.0	1.5	2.8	3.0	2.2	2.0	2.3	2.6	2.2
Rule Management (Iterative)	3.5	3.0	3.5	2.1	3.3	3.0	3.1	1.3	3.1	3.2	2.8	1.5	1.8	2.8	2.0
Data Classification and Tag Mgt	3.0	2.7	3.0	2.5	3.3	3.5	2.9	2.0	3.1	2.8	2.9	1.7	2.6	3.0	1.8
Security	2.9	3.3	3.1	1.9	2.6	3.9	2.7	1.5	3.3	2.6	3.2	1.0	2.6	2.8	1.5
Data Profiling	2.8	3.0	3.2	3.2	2.8	3.1	2.8	1.3	3.2	3.0	2.2	1.2	2.3	2.1	1.3
Matching, Linking, Merging	2.8	1.0	2.7	2.6	2.3	3.5	2.7	1.6	3.2	2.6	1.7	1.0	2.8	2.7	1.2
Analytics Models	2.8	2.5	3.2	2.1	3.0	3.5	2.8	2.0	2.8	2.6	2.2	1.0	2.3	2.9	2.5

Source: Gartner (January 2026)

Table 3 shows the product/service scores for each use case. The scores, which are generated by multiplying the use-case weightings by the product/service ratings, summarize how well the critical capabilities are met for each use case.

Table 3: Product Score in Use Cases

(Enlarged table in Appendix)

Use Cases	Ab Initio	Alation	Alex Solutions	Ataccama	Atlan	BigID	Collibra	DataGalaxy	IBM	Informatica	Microsoft	OvalEdge	Precisely	ServiceNow	Solidatus
Policy Setting	3.19	2.99	3.11	2.54	3.15	3.35	3.09	1.82	3.08	2.70	2.59	2.01	2.30	2.79	2.03
Policy Enforcement (Operational)	3.15	2.86	3.14	2.62	3.05	3.24	3.03	1.78	2.98	2.76	2.34	1.95	2.42	2.75	2.02
Policy Enforcement (Analytical)	3.18	2.91	3.17	2.65	3.10	3.16	3.07	1.75	3.04	2.79	2.41	1.98	2.29	2.74	2.00
Policy Enforcement (Experimental)	3.13	2.95	3.21	2.53	3.10	3.26	3.01	1.73	3.05	2.81	2.51	1.69	2.26	2.76	2.02
Policy Execution	3.18	2.90	3.16	2.60	3.06	3.26	3.11	1.80	3.04	2.76	2.43	2.03	2.41	2.78	2.10

Source: Gartner (January 2026)

To determine an overall score for each product/service in the use cases, multiply the ratings in Table 2 by the weightings shown in Table 1.

Evidence

2025 Gartner Evolution of D&A Governance for AI Survey. This survey was conducted online from 22 July through 4 August to understand how D&A governance has evolved in its mandate and scope in the age of AI. In total, 68 respondents participated, all of which were Research Circle members, a Gartner-managed panel. Respondents were qualified based on their involvement and participation in decision making for data and analytics governance at their organizations in North America (n = 39), EMEA (n = 15), Asia/Pacific (n = 5) and Latin America (n = 9) regions. Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.

Critical Capabilities Methodology

This methodology requires analysts to identify the critical capabilities for a class of products or services. Each capability is then weighted in terms of its relative importance for specific product or service use cases. Next, products/services are rated in terms of how well they achieve each of the critical capabilities. A score that summarizes how well they meet the critical capabilities for each use case is then calculated for each product/service.

"Critical capabilities" are attributes that differentiate products/services in a class in terms of their quality and performance. Gartner recommends that users consider the set of critical capabilities as some of the most important criteria for acquisition decisions.

In defining the product/service category for evaluation, the analyst first identifies the leading uses for the products/services in this market. What needs are end-users looking to fulfill, when considering products/services in this market? Use cases should match common client deployment scenarios. These distinct client scenarios define the Use Cases.

The analyst then identifies the critical capabilities. These capabilities are generalized groups of features commonly required by this class of products/services. Each capability is assigned a level of importance in fulfilling that particular need; some sets of features are more important than others, depending on the use case being evaluated.

Each vendor’s product or service is evaluated in terms of how well it delivers each capability, on a five-point scale. These ratings are displayed side-by-side for all vendors, allowing easy comparisons between the different sets of features.

Ratings and summary scores range from 1.0 to 5.0:

1 = Poor or Absent: most or all defined requirements for a capability are not achieved

2 = Fair: some requirements are not achieved

3 = Good: meets requirements

4 = Excellent: meets or exceeds some requirements

5 = Outstanding: significantly exceeds requirements

To determine an overall score for each product in the use cases, the product ratings are multiplied by the weightings to come up with the product score in use cases.

The critical capabilities Gartner has selected do not represent all capabilities for any product; therefore, may not represent those most important for a specific use situation or business objective. Clients should use a critical capabilities analysis as one of several sources of input about a product before making a product/service decision.

Document Revision History

Critical Capabilities for Data and Analytics Governance Platforms - 7 January 2025

Recommended by the Authors

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

How Products and Services Are Evaluated in Gartner Critical Capabilities

Magic Quadrant for Data and Analytics Governance Platforms

Impact of GenAI on D&A Governance Platform Capabilities

Hype Cycle for Data and Analytics Governance, 2025

2026 Strategic Roadmap for Data and Analytics Governance

Predicts 2026: AI-Driven, Automated, Zero-Trust Governance

Gartner

Table 1: Weighting for Critical Capabilities in Use Cases

Critical Capabilities	*Policy Setting*	*Policy Enforcement (Operational)*	*Policy Enforcement (Analytical)*	*Policy Enforcement (Experimental)*	*Policy Execution*
Data Catalog	10%	5%	15%	10%	10%
Data Dictionary	10%	5%	5%	5%	10%
Business Glossary	5%	5%	5%	5%	0%
Information Policy Representation	20%	5%	5%	5%	5%
Workflow Management	10%	10%	10%	5%	15%
Lineage (Upstream)	5%	15%	5%	5%	10%
Lineage (Downstream)	5%	5%	10%	5%	10%
UI for Stewardship	5%	10%	10%	5%	5%
Rule Management (Traditional)	5%	10%	5%	0%	10%
Rule Management (Iterative)	0%	0%	10%	15%	0%
Data Classification and Tag Mgt	15%	15%	5%	5%	10%

Critical Capabilities	*Policy Setting*	*Policy Enforcement (Operational)*	*Policy Enforcement (Analytical)*	*Policy Enforcement (Experimental)*	*Policy Execution*
Security	10%	5%	5%	10%	10%
Data Profiling	0%	5%	5%	10%	0%
Matching, Linking, Merging	0%	5%	5%	0%	5%
Analytics Models	0%	0%	0%	15%	0%

Gartner (January 2026)

Table 2: Product/Service Rating on Critical Capabilities

Critical Capabilities	*Ab Initio*	*Alation*	*Alex Solutions*	*Ataccama*	*Atlan*	*BigID*	*Collibra*	*DataGalaxy*	*IBM*	*Informatica*	*Microsoft*	*OvalEdge*	*Precisely*	*ServiceNow*	*Solidatus*
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Business Glossary	3.5	2.9	3.0	3.1	3.3	3.1	2.8	2.2	2.7	2.8	2.3	2.2	2.5	3.1	2.0
Information Policy Representation	3.3	3.0	3.0	2.0	3.2	3.6	3.2	1.6	3.3	2.4	2.7	2.0	1.7	2.6	1.9
Workflow Management	2.8	2.7	2.8	2.5	2.9	3.1	3.3	2.0	3.0	2.3	2.2	2.9	2.3	2.7	2.4
Lineage (Upstream)	3.5	3.1	3.5	2.7	3.0	3.2	3.4	1.8	3.0	3.0	2.0	2.1	2.5	3.0	2.5

Critical Capabilities	*Ab Initio*	*Alation*	*Alex Solutions*	*Ataccama*	*Atlan*	*BigID*	*Collibra*	*DataGalaxy*	*IBM*	*Informatica*	*Microsoft*	*OvalEdge*	*Precisely*	*ServiceNow*	*Solidatus*
Lineage (Downstream)	3.5	3.1	3.4	2.8	3.2	2.5	3.4	1.8	2.9	3.1	2.1	2.2	2.6	2.8	2.6
UI for Stewardship	2.6	2.9	2.8	2.5	3.0	2.8	2.4	1.6	2.4	2.3	1.8	1.8	2.4	2.2	1.7
Rule Management (Traditional)	3.5	3.0	3.5	2.3	3.0	3.3	3.0	1.5	2.8	3.0	2.2	2.0	2.3	2.6	2.2
Rule Management (Iterative)	3.5	3.0	3.5	2.1	3.3	3.0	3.1	1.3	3.1	3.2	2.8	1.5	1.8	2.8	2.0
Data Classification and Tag Mgt	3.0	2.7	3.0	2.5	3.3	3.5	2.9	2.0	3.1	2.8	2.9	1.7	2.6	3.0	1.8
Security	2.9	3.3	3.1	1.9	2.6	3.9	2.7	1.5	3.3	2.6	3.2	1.0	2.6	2.8	1.5
Data Profiling	2.8	3.0	3.2	3.2	2.8	3.1	2.8	1.3	3.2	3.0	2.2	1.2	2.3	2.1	1.3
Matching, Linking,	2.8	1.0	2.7	2.6	2.3	3.5	2.7	1.6	3.2	2.6	1.7	1.0	2.8	2.7	1.2

Critical Capabilities	Ab Initio	Alation	Alex Solutions	Ataccama	Atlan	BigID	Collibra	DataGalaxy	IBM	Informatica	Microsoft	OvalEdge	Precisely	ServiceNow	Solidatus
Merging															
Analytics Models	2.8	2.5	3.2	2.1	3.0	3.5	2.8	2.0	2.8	2.6	2.2	1.0	2.3	2.9	2.5

Source: Gartner (January 2026)

Table 3: Product Score in Use Cases

Use Cases	Ab Initio	Alation	Alex Solutions	Ataccama	Atlan	BigID	Collibra	DataGalaxy	IBM	Informatica	Microsoft	OvalEdge	Precisely	ServiceNow	Solidatus
Policy Setting	3.19	2.99	3.11	2.54	3.15	3.35	3.09	1.82	3.08	2.70	2.59	2.01	2.30	2.79	2.03
Policy Enforcement (Operational)	3.15	2.86	3.14	2.62	3.05	3.24	3.03	1.78	2.98	2.76	2.34	1.95	2.42	2.75	2.02
Policy Enforcement (Analytical)	3.18	2.91	3.17	2.65	3.10	3.16	3.07	1.75	3.04	2.79	2.41	1.98	2.29	2.74	2.00
Policy Enforcement (Experimental)	3.13	2.95	3.21	2.53	3.10	3.26	3.01	1.73	3.05	2.81	2.51	1.69	2.26	2.76	2.02
Policy Execution	3.18	2.90	3.16	2.60	3.06	3.26	3.11	1.80	3.04	2.76	2.43	2.03	2.41	2.78	2.10

Source: Gartner (January 2026)